Barrows & Basilisks v1.09

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Character Creation

Basic Rules

If coming from other old-school games, these are the assumptions used for a few important rules:

- No ability scores.
- HD are d6.
- Reroll all HD each session or each long rest.
- To-hit bonus equal to HD.
- Ascending AC with unarmored AC = 10.
- Single saving throw (roll-over).

Advantage & Disadvantage When a character has advantage on a roll, roll two dice instead of one and take the better result. When a character has disadvantage on a roll, roll two dice instead of one and take the worse result.

Experience & Advancement

Pick a class. Start at 1st level with 0 experience points (XP) and 3d6x10 silver pieces (sp). Gain 1 XP for every coin spent on carousing, partying, donating, gambling, or other pursuits without material reward. Slaying monsters may award XP as well, but this is significantly more dangerous and less rewarding than stealing treasure.

Fighter

Weapons Any
Armor Any
Shields? Yes
Name Level When they reach 9th level, they become a Lord (or Lady) and can rule over a manor and its subjects.
Cleave Upon slaying an enemy, a fighter may immediately make an additional attack against an enemy within reach.

Table 1: Fighter Levels

Level	XP	HD	To-Hit	Save
1	0	1	+1	14+
2	2,000	2	+2	13+
3	4,000	3	+3	12+
4	8,000	4	+4	11+
5	16,000	5	+5	10+
6	32,000	6	+6	9+
7	64,000	7	+7	8+
8	128,000	8	+8	7+
9	256,000	9	+9	6+

Cleric

Weapons Simple **Armor** Medium
Shields? Yes
Name Level When they reach 9th level, they become a High Priest (or Priestess) and can build or take over a temple.

Table 2: Cleric Levels

Level	XP	HD	To-Hit	Save
1	0	1	+1	14+
2	2,000	1	+1	13+
3	4,000	2	+2	12+
4	8,000	2	+2	11+
5	16,000	3	+3	10+
6	32,000	3	+3	9+
7	64,000	4	+4	8+
8	128,000	4	+4	7+
9	256,000	5	+5	6+

Table 3: Cleric Spells per Day by Level

Level	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th
1					
2	1				
3	2				
4	3	1			
5	4	2			
6	4	2	1		

Level	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th
7	4	3	2		
8	4	3	2	1	
9	4	4	3	2	1

Mage

Weapons Simple
Armor None **Shields?** No
Name Level When they reach 9th level, they become a Wizard (or Witch), and can build a tower (or hut) to train apprentices.
Spellcasting Mages may memorize and cast a number of spells per day of a maximum spell level as indicated by the table below. Mages start with three 1st level spells written in their grimoire, and can transcribe more into their grimoire from scrolls. Mages must have their grimoire (a *bulky* item) to memorize any spells.

Table 4: Mage Levels

Level	XP	HD	To-Hit	Save
1	0	1	+1	16+
2	2,500	1	+1	15+
3	5,000	1	+1	14+
4	10,000	2	+2	13+
5	20,000	2	+2	12+
6	40,000	2	+2	11+
7	80,000	3	+3	10+
8	160,000	3	+3	9+
9	320,000	3	+3	8+

Table 5: Mage Spells per Day by Level

Level	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th
1	1					
2	2					
3	3	1				
4	4	2				
5	4	2	1			
6	4	3	2			
7	4	3	2	1		
8	4	4	3	2	1	

Level	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th
9	4	4	3	2	2	1

Equipment

Encumbrance and Movement

Unencumbered Load A man can carry up to ten (10) items. Some items are *bulky* – these require two hands to carry or wield, and count as two items for encumbrance purposes. Some items are *tiny* – any number of the same type of *tiny* items fit into the same slot. A purse of 300 coins counts as one item.

Encumbered Load A man can carry up to an additional ten (10) items (for a total of twenty). When they are carrying more than ten items, they are *encumbered*, and movement speed is halved. When mounted, movement speed in combat is doubled.

Items

Supply Common adventuring equipment and resources are abstracted into *supply*. Each unit of *supply* takes up one (1) slot, costs 10 coins, and can be readily converted into...

- Rations, one (1) day
- Water, one (1) day
- Torches, three (3)
- Ammunition for one (1) missile weapon
- A common tool, such as a shovel, pickaxe, oar, rope, or the like.
- Camping equipment suitable for a night in the wilderness.
- Any other miscellaneous common item that the GM deems appropriate.

Table 6: Armor and Shields

Armor	AC	Cost	Encumbrance as...	Examples
Unarmored	10	-	-	-
Light Armor	12	10sp	2 items	Padded armor, quilted gambeson, mail shirt
Medium Armor	14	250sp	4 items	Mail hauberk, splint armor, brigandine
Heavy Armor	16	3,000sp	6 items	Bronze breastplate, full plate harness

Armor	AC	Cost	Encumbrance as...	Examples
Shield	+1	10sp	1 item	

Shield, Wooden: The typical shield, 10sp. Can be splintered to negate damage from a single melee or missile attack.
Shield, Leaden: Grants advantage to saves vs. magic. Encumbrance as *bulky*, 50sp.
Shield, Mirrored Bronze: Grants advantage to saves vs. gaze attacks, 100sp.

Table 7: Weapons

Weapon	Damage	Special	Cost	Examples
Simple Hand	d4		10	Dagger, club, hatchet
Simple Polearm	d6	bulky	15	Staff, pitchfork, billhook
Martial Hand	d6		20	Sword, spear, mace
Martial Polearm	d8	bulky	25	Poleaxe, halberd, lance
Missile, Sling	d4		10	Sling
Missile, Bow	d6	bulky	25	Hunting bow, light crossbow
Unarmed	1		-	

Bulky weapons must be wielded in two hands, in addition to counting as two items for encumbrance purposes.
Missile weapons may be loosed in the missile phase of combat, and require ammunition. Roll a d6 after each combat in which a missile weapon was used. On a 1 or 2, you are out of ammo.

Table 8: Transportaion

Transport	Cost
Cart, hand	5sp
Cart, draft	10sp
Wagon	30sp
Mule	30sp
Horse	50sp
Warhorse	100sp
Canoe	50sp
Longship	10,000sp

Carts double (2x) the carrying capacity of the user.
Wagons quadruple (4x) the carrying capacity of the user.
Mules have a morale score of 7, and are only as fast as a walking person.

Horses have a morale score of 6.
Warhorses have a morale score of 9.
Canoe Carries 2 men and 300 items of cargo, counts as a *bulky* item when portaging.
Longships can carry 40 oarsmen, and sail at speeds of 10 mph.

Mounts such as mules and horses can carry up to 40 items when unencumbered, or up to 80 items when encumbered. Each rider counts as 20 items for the purposes of carrying capacity.

Hirelings

It costs 100c to place an advertisement in a settlement for hirelings. The advertisement lasts for 1 week and provides d6+1 prospects for hiring. Hirelings are not brave or foolhardy enough to enter dungeons, but can be used for logistical support to and from dungeons and for guarding camp.

Table 9: Hirelings

Type	Notes	Cost per Month
Servant	HD1/2 AC10 DMGd4 M6	4sp
Foot, Light	HD1 AC14 DMGd6 M7	20sp
Foot, Armored	HD1 AC16 DMGd6 M8	40sp
Foot, Archer	HD1 AC12 DMGd6 M7	60sp
Horse, Light	HD2 AC14 DMGd6 M7	100sp
Horse, Armored	HD2 AC16 DMGd8 M8	160sp
Horse, Archer	HD2 AC12 DMGd6 M8	160sp
Armorer	Need 1 per 50 soldiers	100sp
Blacksmith	Need 1 per 50 mounts	20sp
Engineer	Builds strongholds	800sp

Horse archers may act in both the move phase and the missile phase of combat.

Encounters

Surprise

To determine surprise, roll a d6 for each side that is unaware of their enemies. On a 1 or 2, they are surprised. If a side is surprised, they are unable to act in the first round of combat.

Common situations where players may surprise monsters:.

- Bursting through a door on the first try.
- Entering a room by picking the a locked door.
- A thief successfully hides in shadows or moves silently (only the thief has a chance to surprise).

Common situations where monsters may surprise players:

- The party has no light sources.
- The party enters a room after an unsuccessful attempt to force the door, if the party did not hear any noises before entering.

Reactions

When encountering a wandering monster or other entity, and their disposition is unknown, roll 2d6 to determine their reaction.

Table 10: Reaction Roll Results

2d6	Reaction
2-	Hostile
3-5	Negative
6-8	Uncertain
9-11	Positive
12+	Enthusiastic

Distance

Wandering monster encounters take place at the following distance, depending on location and whether any parties are surprised.

Table 11: Distance of Encounters

	Indoor	Outdoor
Surprised	1 move away	1d4 moves away
Not Surprised	1d4 moves away	4d6 moves away

Combat

Initiative

To determine initiative within the combat round, each side rolls a d6 at the start of combat. The side with the highest result has the initiative. Combatants take their actions in the following phases, with the side having the initiative acting first in each phase:

1. **Magic, cast**

2. **Missile**
3. **Move**
4. **Melee**
5. **Magic, effect**

Attacks & Damage

Basic Attacks Roll a d20 and add to-hit bonus. Results that are equal to or greater than the target's armor class (AC) deal the weapon's damage to the target. The target reduces their HP by that much. Attack rolls of 20 are critical hits – roll twice as many damage dice.

Charge In the first round of combat, a combatant may charge an enemy by moving from outside of melee range to within melee range of an enemy in the movement phase. The charging combatant gains advantage on their next attack against the charged enemy, and successful attacks deal double damage.

Withdraw When a combatant within melee range of an enemy moves out of melee range, the enemy may immediately make a melee attack against the combatant. This can be avoided if the combatant only makes a half move.

Combat Maneuvers A combatant can choose to trip, disarm, blind, or otherwise perform a dirty trick on his opponent. He makes an attack and damage roll as normal. If he hits, his opponent can choose to take damage as normal, or suffer the effects of the combat manuever.

Saving Throws

Some effects require characters to make saving throws. To do so, roll a d20 and compare the result to the character's saving throw score on their character sheet. A result equal to or greater than the saving throw score is a success.

Death & Healing

Bind Wounds Characters may bind their wounds after combat to restore 1d6 HP of damage sustained in that fight.

Reroll HP Resting in camp or town for a night allows characters to reroll all of their HD. If the total of the results is greater than their current HP, the total becomes their new HP. If a character is lacking food, water, or shelter, they are *deprived* and cannot reroll HP.

Grievous Wounds When a combatant reaches 0 HP, they must make a saving throw. On a failure, they die. On a success, they are merely grievously wounded – roll on the table below to determine their injuries. When grievously wounded, characters require a week's rest in camp or town to reroll HP (instead of a night's rest).

Table 12: Grevious Wounds

d6	Grevious Wound
1	**Gruesome Scars** -1 to reaction rolls.
2	**Eye Gouged Out** Disadvantage on ranged attacks. If this happens twice, they are blinded.
3	**Broken Arm** Disadvantage to all actions with that arm / hand. Heals in 1d4 weeks.
4	**Broken Leg** Move speed and carrying capacity halved. Heals in 1d4 weeks.
5	**Dismembered, Arm** Lose an arm.
6	**Dismembered, Leg** Lose a leg. Move speed and carrying capacity halved.

Morale

When a side takes 50% casualties, make a morale check to see if they break. Roll 2d6; a result greater than the morale score means that the side routs and flees the field. Morale is usually based on the combatants experience level, per the table below.

Undead are always hostile, never check morale, and normally cannot be reasoned with (intelligent undead such as liches are an exception).

Table 13: Morale Scores

Experience	Morale Score	Examples
Green	6	Conscripts, levy
Trained	7	Militia, town guards
Veteran	8	Experienced fighters
Elite	9	Knights, house guards

Evasion

Evasion and Surprise If the party surprises a monster, they can evade the monster automatically by retreating from the dungeon room or taking a circuitous wilderness path.

Fleeing If the monster is not surprised, and the party tries to flee, the monsters may give chase if the reaction roll indicates it. To successfully flee from a pursuer, the fleeing characters must each make a saving throw. Encumbered characters have disadvantage on this saving throw. Unarmored characters have advantage on this saving throw. Failure means the monster catches up, and resumes its attack.

Distractions Food will always distract unintelligent monsters from the chase, by dropping 1 day's ration per monster HD. Treasure will always distract intelligent monsters from the chase, by dropping 100c worth of treasure or coins per monster HD. Passing through a secret door will always evade a pursuer.

Dungeon Delving

Turns

One turn of dungeon exploration takes about ten (10) minutes, and generally allows the party to take one action, such as:

- Move to the next room
- Open a stuck or locked door
- Search the current room
- Rest and bind wounds
- Interact with a feature of the room, such as a trap

Doors

Forcing Doors All doors are stuck and must be burst open by force with a 5+ on a d6. A failed attempt makes surprising whatever is behind the door impossible.

Hear Noises Characters can listen at doors and attempt to hear if the room is occupied on a roll of 5+ on a d6. Note that the undead make no sound.

Secret doors require the room they are in to be searched completely (takes one turn, sometimes more for larger rooms) Some doors are locked, and require a key or a thief to pick the lock to open.

Spiking Doors Doors will open freely for monsters unless wedged shut with iron spikes. When wedged shut, monsters must attempt to burst the door open as above, possibly giving the party time to hear them coming. Doors can also be wedged open with spikes, to ensure the party a clear path of escape.

Holding Doors Sometimes (especially during a chase) the party will try to hold a door against pursing monsters. The side trying to force a held door must try to burst it open as normal (5+ on a d6).

Traps

Room Traps are activated on a roll of 1 or 2 on a d6. They can be detected by spending a turn searching the area. Thieves can attempt to disarm traps; but be careful, as a failure will trigger the trap. If the character doesn't want to risk this, find a clever way to bypass the trap.

Treasure Traps such as locks with poison needles, or a weighted plate underneath a statuette, can only be detected by a thief spending a turn searching the treasure. Thieves can attempt to disarm them, but failure will trigger the trap.

Wandering Monsters

Every turn of exploration, or every time the party rests or makes excessive noise, roll a d6 on the event table below. Choose the result from the appropriate column depending on whether all, some, or none of the characters in the party have light.

Table 14: Dungeon Event Rolls

d6	Fully Lit	Partially Lit	Unlit
1	W	W	W
2	O	W	W
3	L	L	W
4	-	-	-
5	-	-	-
6	-	-	-

W = Wandering monster encounter. Roll for an encounter on the appropriate encounter table.
O = Omen. Signs of a wandering monster are encountered.
L = Light sources depleted. All currently lit light sources are depleted. New light sources are automatically lit as a free action (unless in combat, see **tinderbox** rules).

Appendix

Monsters, Treasure, & Spells

It is suggested to reference one of the following resources for monster lists, treasure tables, and spell lists:

- *White Box: Fantastic Medieval Adventure Game* by Charles Mason
- *Delving Deeper Reference Rules Hypertext* by Simon J. Bull
  - Monsters
  - Treasure
  - Spells

Monsters by HD

Monsters are able to see in complete darkness. When converting monsters from other publications, their saving throw and to-hit bonus should be based on the number of HD. A monster's saving throw is found by subtracting it's HD from 19 (for example, a 2 HD monster has a saving throw of 17). A monster has a to-hit bonus equal to its HD. HD should be converted to d6. Monsters typically deal d6 damage per attack, though particularly dangerous monsters might deal multiple d6 per attack.

Table 15: Monsters by HD

HD	HP	To-Hit Bonus	Saving Throw	XP Awarded
<1	2	+0	19+	10
1	4	+1	18+	15
2	8	+2	17+	30
3	12	+3	16+	60
4	16	+4	15+	120
5	20	+5	14+	240
6	24	+6	13+	400
7	28	+7	12+	600
8	32	+8	11+	800

HD	HP	To-Hit Bonus	Saving Throw	XP Awarded
9	36	+9	10+	1100
10	40	+10	9+	1400
11	44	+11	8+	1700
12	48	+12	7+	2000
13	52	+13	6+	2300
14	56	+14	5+	2600
15	60	+15	4+	2900